

以定位到③⑤句,③句提到“文化之城”取得的成功(巨额投资和艺术发展)不应局限于城市,暗示小镇也应享有艺术发展和巨额投资;⑤句直接指出“文化之镇”奖带来的经济意义,正确答案中的 increase economic strength 正是对原文的同义替换。

II ① Some might see the proposal as a booby prize for the fact that Britain is no longer able to apply for the much more prestigious^① title of European capital of culture, a sought-after^② award bagged^③ by Glasgow in 1990 and Liverpool in 2008. ② A cynic^④ might speculate^⑤ that the UK is on the verge of disappearing into an endless fever of self-celebration^⑥ in its desperation^⑦ to reinvent itself for the post-Brexit world: after town of culture, who knows what will follow—village of culture? Suburb of culture? Hamlet^⑧ of culture?

有些人也许会认为上述提议不过是个安慰奖,因为英国已经不再有资格去申请更具声望的“欧洲文化之都”称号了。“欧洲文化之都”是一个备受青睐的奖项,被格拉斯哥和利物浦分别于1990年和2008年收入囊中。怀疑者可能会推测,英国迫切想要在脱欧后的世界展现新形象,即将湮没于无休止的自我庆祝的狂热之中:文化之镇之后,谁知道还会有什么称号呢—文化之乡?文化之郊?文化之村?

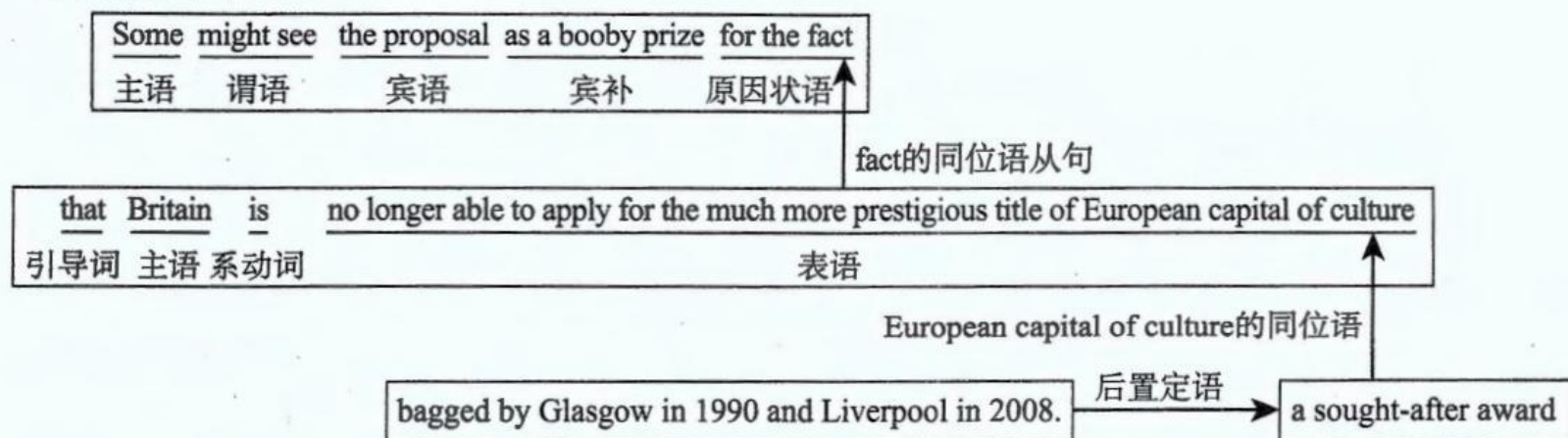
· 词汇注释与难句分析 ·

- ① prestigious [pre'stɪdʒəs] a. 有威望的,声誉高的
② sought-after ['sɔ:təftə] a. 争相获得的,受欢迎的
③ bag [bæg] v. 抢占,占有
④ cynic ['sɪnɪk] n. 悲观者;怀疑者
⑤ speculate ['spekjuleɪt] v. 推测,猜测
⑥ self-celebration n. 自我庆祝,自我赞美

- ⑦ desperation [ˌdespə'reɪʃən] n. 极度渴望;拼命
⑧ hamlet ['hæmlət] n. 小村庄
● 经典搭配
① booby prize (安慰奖)
② on the verge of (濒于……,即将)
③ reinvent oneself (以新形象示人)

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结构切分:



功能注释:句子主干是 Some might see the proposal as a booby prize, for the fact that... 作原因状语, that 引导的同位语从句解释 fact 的具体内容。同位语从句的主干为 Britain is no longer able to apply for the much more prestigious title of European capital of culture。其后的 a sought-after award... 2008 是 European capital of culture 的同位语,过去分词短语 bagged by Glasgow in 1990 and Liverpool in 2008 作后置定语修饰 award。

· 语篇分析 ·

第二段为第二部分,呈现质疑者对新提议的看法:英国脱欧后,因无法再申请“欧洲文化之都”,退而求其次设立“文化之镇”奖,不过是自欺欺人的自我庆祝罢了。关键词:①booby prize;②cynic。

①句引出质疑者观点:“文化之镇”只是个安慰奖。Some might see 呼应首段 Cooper and her colleagues argue,标志着不同声音的出现。booby prize(a prize that is given as a joke to the person who is